

Arithmetic and complexity

Deterministic polynomial-time commutative Edmonds problem

Difficulty: extreme **Importance:** broadly interesting**Status:** Partially resolved

Rating rationale: Extreme because deterministic symbolic nonsingularity is a central derandomization barrier; broad importance links matrix-space rank, polynomial identity testing and complexity theory.

Provenance: source-stated problem, with rational input and bit complexity made explicit.

The input consists of positive integers n, s and matrices $A_1, \dots, A_s \in \mathbb{Q}^{n \times n}$, with rational entries represented by signed binary numerators and positive binary denominators. Does there exist a deterministic algorithm, running in a number of bit operations bounded by a polynomial in the total binary input length, that decides whether

$$\det\left(\sum_{i=1}^s x_i A_i\right)$$

is the zero polynomial in the commuting indeterminates $x_1, \dots, x_s$ over $\mathbb{Q}$?

Equivalently, decide whether the rational linear space

$$\left\{ \sum_{i=1}^s c_i A_i : c_1, \dots, c_s \in \mathbb{Q} \right\}$$

contains a nonsingular matrix. No prescribed matrix structure is assumed.

This is exact rank and nonsingularity testing for a parametrized matrix space. Random evaluation gives a randomized route; the problem asks whether randomness can be eliminated while retaining polynomial running time.

References

1. C. Chindris and D. Kline, *Edmonds' problem and the membership problem for orbit semigroups of quiver representations*, arXiv:2008.13648 (2020), introduction: the general deterministic nonsingularity problem and the special classes treated in the paper. [Paper](#).
2. G. Ivanyos, M. Karpinski, Y. Qiao, and M. Santha, *Generalized Wong sequences and their applications to Edmonds' problems*, arXiv:1307.6429v2 (2014), abstract and introduction: symbolic determinant identity testing, including the rational field and algorithms for restricted matrix spaces. [Paper](#).
3. A. Chatterjee, S. Ghosh, R. Gurjar, R. Raj, and T. Thierauf, *Bipartite Matching is in NC*, ECCC TR26-100, revision 2 (2026), Section 1.1, "Non-commutative rank": explicitly distinguishes the still-open deterministic commutative rank problem. [Report and version history](#).

Status check — 2026-09-10

Rechecked [Chatterjee et al., ECCC TR26-100, §1.1](#), and searched for later commutative Edmonds algorithms. The July 2026 revision explicitly states that no deterministic polynomial-time algorithm is known generally. [Ivanyos et al.](#) gives algorithms for restricted matrix spaces, substantive solved subclasses. Deterministic noncommutative-rank algorithms and bipartite matching do not settle unrestricted commuting symbolic determinants. No full resolution was located.